

Lab: Pattern Design Workshop — Modifying the Pattern Mid-Row

Objective

Practice deliberate pattern modification and develop awareness of the decision-making processes involved in acting on your work to align it with your intentions.

Materials Needed

- A simple crochet pattern (dishcloth or small accessory)
- Two sets of hook and yarn in the same weight but different hook sizes (e.g., 4mm and 5.5mm)
- Journal or notebook
- Stitch markers

Exercise 1: Stitch Substitution Comparison (40 minutes)

Make the same pattern twice with one systematic substitution:

- Version A: Follow the pattern exactly as written
- Version B: Replace every double crochet with half double crochet (or vice versa)

Compare the two finished pieces:

Property	Version A (original)	Version B (substituted)
Width		
Length		
Drape		
Texture		
Density		
Yarn used		

Discuss: How accurately did you predict the effects of the substitution before making it? What surprised you?

Exercise 2: The Frogging Decision Log (30 minutes)

Work a practice swatch and intentionally introduce three different types of errors: 1. Skip one stitch in a row (a small, hard-to-see error) 2. Use the wrong stitch for an entire row (a large, visible error) 3. Add an extra stitch in the middle of a row (a medium error)

For each error, pause and make a deliberate frogging decision. Record:

Error	Visibility	Structural Impact	Frogging Cost	Decision	Reasoning
1					
2					
3					

Reflect: What factors drove your decisions? How did the precision of the error signal (how visible and structurally important the error is) affect your choice?

Exercise 3: Guided Improvisation (30 minutes)

Starting with a foundation chain of 20, crochet freely for 15 minutes. The only rule: after every 2 rows, write down: - What you predicted would happen - What actually happened - What you plan to do next and why

This exercise makes the active inference loop visible: predict, act, observe, decide.

Exercise 4: Size Modification Challenge (20 minutes)

Take a simple pattern designed for one size (e.g., a baby hat) and plan the modifications needed to make it in a different size (e.g., adult). Write out:

1. What numbers must change (stitch counts, row counts)
2. What proportions must stay the same (crown-to-brim ratio)
3. What new calculations are needed

Discuss: Which parts of the modification were straightforward re-parameterization, and which required deeper understanding of the pattern's structure?

Discussion Questions for the Circle

1. When you modify a pattern, do you plan the modifications before starting, or do you decide as you go? What drives your approach?
2. What is your personal frogging threshold — how much error can you tolerate before you rip it out?
3. Have you ever improvised something you were proud of? What made the improvisation successful?

Wrap-Up

Write a brief reflection (3-5 sentences) on your relationship with pattern modification. Are you a strict pattern follower, an eager modifier, or an improviser? How does your approach connect to your generative model's confidence?